paragraph in a report was anything but a repetition of a paragraph in some earlier Navy Yard report.

Preparing my dissertation with Dawson had been an unsettling experience, but I found that writing papers on my own was no better. Such papers had to pass the eagle eyes of Walker and Lemon and then, on being submitted to a journal, had to undergo the dour glances of nameless reviewers. In the end, nothing got through but well-chewed cud.

I might not have minded, but I felt myself to be a writer, and I hated having my name on such limp and bedraggled material.

2 4

On March 13, Brad called me. He was rejecting the new version of The Stars, like Dust—. It was still too overwritten and I would have to try again. He was sending the copy back, copiously red-penciled. After the glorious beginning of the year, it looked as though I were roller-coasting downward again.

On that same day, however, Fred Pohl wrote me concerning "Little Man on the Subway," the story we had collaborated on ten years before. It was to appear in a little semipro magazine called Fantasy Book. It was a short-lived magazine that only put out about nine copies, but "Little Man on the Subway" appeared in the sixth and eventually I got a copy of that magazine and there was the story in it, and in the lead position, too. 6

The longest story in that issue was "Scanners Live in Vain" by an unknown called Cordwainer Smith. I read it and thought it very unusual but very depressing. It turned out that in later years it was consid-

6 See The Early Asimov.

ered a classic, and Smith (a pseudonym) went on to become what was almost a cult object.

The payment for "Little Man on the Subway" was $10, of which I only got half, of course. It was the first time I had a science-fiction story appear in any magazine but Astounding in eight years.

Fred then sent me word that he had also sold the other story on which we had co-operated, "Legal Rites." This one went to Weird Tales, and the payment was $40 for each of us.